ZikShare

ACADEMIC VAULT

UNIZIK FRESHER EDITION | 2026

THA 162: Basic Theatre Administration and Management

Budgets, schedules, people and the business of putting on a show

THEATRE & FILM

Theatre & Film Studies

Faculty of Arts
Theatre & Film Studies | 100L

OUTLINE ARCHIVE: 2018 - 2019 - 2025/2026

Written for students, by students.

Practical notes, worked examples, practice questions and a revision plan.

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Independent study support | Not an official UNIZIK publication

START HERE

Why this pack exists

Productions fail on logistics more often than on talent. This pack covers organisational structures, budgeting and break-even, scheduling, front-of-house and box office, contracts and basic stage management paperwork, with templates you can adapt for a campus production.

This is a student-written study companion, not a reproduced lecture handout or a leaked examination paper. Use it to organise the topics you are taught, practise the kind of thinking your course rewards, and walk into class with better questions.

What you will be able to do

- Describe the structure of a theatre organisation and who reports to whom.
- Prepare a simple production budget and calculate break-even attendance.
- Build a rehearsal and production schedule with dependencies.
- Explain the stage manager's paperwork and communication role.

How to use this pack

1. Skim the whole pack once in 20 minutes so you know what is inside.
2. Work through one section at a time with your lecture note and recommended text beside you.
3. Attempt the practice questions before reading the answers. Mark what you missed.
4. Use the final checklist to plan your revision week, one tick per study session.

> **Free to download, always**
> This pack is free. There is no fee, no subscription and no payment step before download, and the full PDF is not watermarked or locked. Share the link with a coursemate instead of forwarding the file.

> **Confirm your official course outline**
> Course codes, credit units and outlines can differ by department and session. Treat this pack as supplementary support and confirm the current outline with your lecturer, course rep or departmental handbook before an assessment.

Structure and governance

A theatre company is an organisation with money, people and obligations.

- Artistic leadership shapes the season and creative decisions.
- Administration handles finance, contracts, marketing and facilities.
- Technical and production staff deliver the physical event.
- Board or management oversight protects the organisation's sustainability.
- Roles can overlap in student productions, but responsibility must be written down.
- Know who can authorise spending before you spend.

Budget and break-even

A budget is a plan with assumptions you can defend.

- Fixed costs: venue, equipment hire, insurance, rights.
- Variable costs: costumes, props, printing, refreshments per performance.
- Revenue: ticket sales, sponsorship, concessions, merchandise.
- Break-even attendance equals fixed costs divided by contribution per ticket.
- Keep a contingency of roughly ten percent for surprises.
- Reconcile actuals against the budget after the production.

> **Rights are not optional**
> Performing a copyrighted play without permission exposes the production to legal action. Budget for rights from the start.

Scheduling and stage management

The stage manager is the production's communication spine.

- Work backwards from the performance date to set deadlines.
- Build a rehearsal calendar around cast availability and venue access.
- Stage manager's book: script, blocking notes, cue sheets and contact list.
- Rehearsal reports record attendance, progress and problems.
- Cue sequences for lighting, sound and scene changes must be rehearsed.
- Front-of-house plans cover ticketing, ushering, safety and accessibility.

OUTLINE ARCHIVE

Session record: THA 162

2018 - 2019 - 2025/2026

Year demarcation matters: a course code that existed in 2018 may have been renumbered, merged or dropped by 2019, and the department now also runs a film track. Read the year label before you rely on a code. The current entry below is a compiled map - take it to your course rep or the departmental office and confirm it before registration.

2018 — Archived course description — ARCHIVED

- THA 162 Basic Theatre Administration and Management
- Structure, organographies, resource management and the rules of conduct governing theatre business
- Application of theatre principles to education, management and policy

Source: unizik.edu.ng - Theatre & Film Studies course description (page dated 31 May 2018; original URL now returns 404) (retrieved 2026-10-22)

2019 — Archived programme listing — ARCHIVED

- THA 162 Basic Theatre Administration and Management, 3 credits, second semester
- THA 261 Theatre in Education and Community and THA 262 Administering Theatre in Educational Establishments follow
- THA 315 Theatre, Art and Culture in Public Relations and Tourism extends the administration track

What changed: The 2019 listing formalises an administration ladder across 100, 200 and 300 level.

Source: arts.unizik.edu.ng - Theatre Arts programme and course map (page dated 18 Oct 2019; original URL now returns 404) (retrieved 2026-10-22)

2025/2026 — Compiled working map — CURRENT WORKING MAP

- Basic administration remains the 100-level entry to the administration and applied theatre stress area
- Assessment typically combines a budget exercise with a written management answer
- Confirm whether rights and insurance are covered in your taught component

Source: Compiled by ZikShare from the archived 2018 and 2019 departmental pages plus the published stress areas; this is a working map, not an official handout (retrieved 2026-10-22)

Archive means: this records what a public departmental page listed in that year. It is not a guarantee of the current curriculum, and ZikShare is not affiliated with UNIZIK.

PRACTICE, NOT PREDICTION

Check your understanding

These questions are written for this pack to test the ideas above. They are not past examination questions and do not predict what your lecturer will set. Answer first, then compare.

1. Fixed costs are 120,000 and each ticket yields 1,500 after variable costs. Find break-even attendance.

Answer: 120,000 divided by 1,500 equals 80 tickets.

2. What is a contingency and why keep one?

Answer: A reserve, typically around ten percent, to cover unforeseen costs without cancelling the production.

3. List four items in a stage manager's book.

Answer: Script with blocking, cue sheets, contact list and rehearsal reports.

4. Why must you budget for performance rights?

Answer: Performing copyrighted work without permission is an infringement and can lead to cancellation or legal claims.

5. What does a rehearsal report contain?

Answer: Date, attendees, work covered, scenes or cues rehearsed, issues arising and actions assigned.

Your 7-step action plan

Tick each step only when you have done it. A tick you cannot defend is worse than an empty box.

- [ ] Draw an organisational chart for a student production.
- [ ] Build a budget with fixed, variable and contingency lines.
- [ ] Calculate break-even for a 200-seat hall.
- [ ] Create a rehearsal calendar working back from opening night.
- [ ] Write one rehearsal report template.
- [ ] List the safety and front-of-house tasks for a show.
- [ ] Interview a production manager or stage manager about one real problem.

Keep going

One pack will not carry a semester. Pair this with your lecture notes, tutorials, and the past questions your department actually releases. If a topic still feels unclear, take a specific question to your lecturer or course rep - "I do not understand the difference between X and Y" gets a better answer than "I do not understand this course".

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YOUR WORKSPACE

Notes, questions and things to ask

Use this page in class or during revision. Write questions you could not answer instead of copying slides.

Three ideas I can now explain without notes:

A question I still cannot answer:

For my lecturer or course rep:

Next revision action and date:

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